

The following query in Postgres:

```
DELETE FROM timeouts
      WHERE last_seen < $1
      RETURNING peer, game, lobbies
      LIMIT 1
```

Returns

syntax error at or near "LIMIT" (SQLSTATE 42601)

How do I fix this?

The `DELETE` statement in PostgreSQL does not support a `LIMIT` clause directly. The error you're seeing is due to the presence of the `LIMIT 1` clause in your `DELETE` statement.

To delete a limited number of rows, you can use a Common Table Expression (CTE) with the `DELETE` statement. Here's a way you can modify your query to delete a single row (similar to using `LIMIT 1`) based on your provided conditions:

sql

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```
WITH deleted_rows AS (
    SELECT peer, game, lobbies
    FROM timeouts
    WHERE last_seen < $1
    LIMIT 1
)
DELETE FROM timeouts
USING deleted_rows
WHERE timeouts.peer = deleted_rows.peer
AND timeouts.game = deleted_rows.game
AND timeouts.lobbies = deleted_rows.lobbies
RETURNING deleted_rows.peer, deleted_rows.game, deleted_rows.lobbies;
```

This CTE selects the first row matching your condition, then deletes only that row from the `timeouts` table.

Do note that this approach can be less performant than a straightforward `DELETE` when working with large tables, but for small operations, the difference is often negligible. If you frequently find yourself needing to delete a small number of rows based on complex criteria, this method should be suitable.